

Since you asked for a detailed summary to save for later implementation, here's the consolidated version with the wildcard subdomain roadmap incorporated.

 Edit



Game Foundry Studio - Game Ecosystem, Discovery, and Domain Strategy

Vision

Game Foundry Studio should not simply host games.

Game Foundry Studio should host complete game ecosystems.

A game is more than:

- Play

A game ecosystem includes:

- Play
- Learn
- Collect
- Compete
- Discuss
- Share
- Purchase
- Return

The long-term goal is to keep players inside the GFS ecosystem while still allowing creators to establish their own brands.

Core Principle

Every published game automatically receives an official home inside GFS.

Example:

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether

This page is permanent and cannot be removed.

It serves as:

- Discovery page
- SEO page
- Community page
- Marketplace page
- Analytics page
- Canonical game page

Even if the creator later uses custom domains, the canonical GFS page remains.

Ecosystem Pages

Every published game automatically receives:

[/overview](#)

[/news](#)

[/challenges](#)

[/events](#)

[/wiki](#)

[/store](#)

[/media](#)

[/community](#)

[/leaderboards](#)

[/achievements](#)

[/rewards](#)

[/patch-notes](#)

Examples:

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether/news

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether/challenges

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether/wiki

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether/store

These pages are generated using templates.

Creators provide content.

GFS provides structure.

Challenge and Reward Loop

Primary objective:

Drive players from the game back into GFS.

Example:

Daily Challenge

Visit the Dragon Archives.

Link:

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether/challenges/dragon-of-the-day

Reward:

- Gems
- Energy
- XP
- Cosmetic Items
- Crafting Materials

Player Flow:

Game



Challenge Page



Reward Claim



Back To Game

This creates recurring engagement with GFS itself.

Challenge Types

Knowledge Challenge

- Read article
- Answer question
- Receive reward

Exploration Challenge

- Find hidden code
- Receive reward

Community Challenge

- Vote
- Discuss
- Participate
- Receive reward

Creator Spotlight

- Read creator content
- Receive reward

Marketplace Promotion

- View item
- Receive reward

Store Integration

Future creator monetization.

Example:

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether/store

Possible contents:

- Cosmetic packs
- Character skins
- Expansion packs
- Supporter packs
- Soundtracks
- Wallpapers
- Merchandise links

All template driven.

All creator managed.

Membership Philosophy

Do NOT make ecosystem pages Founder-only.

Do NOT make ecosystem pages Studio-only.

Do NOT make ecosystem pages Pro-only.

Every published game should receive ecosystem pages.

Reason:

The value of GFS grows through content volume.

Desired outcome:

100 games

100 ecosystems

Not:

100 games

5 ecosystems

Free Plan

Includes:

- Game page
- News
- Challenges
- Wiki
- Community
- Achievements
- Rewards

Required branding:

Powered by Game Foundry Studio

Creator Plan

Adds:

- Additional projects
 - More storage
 - Marketplace publishing
 - Advanced analytics
 - Premium page templates
 - Additional AI credits
-

Studio Plan

Adds:

- Teams
 - Enterprise analytics
 - Higher limits
 - White-label options
 - Additional AI credits
-

Domain Strategy

Custom domains should be a sidecar service.

Not a membership feature.

Creators should be able to buy membership levels without being forced to buy domains.

Bring Your Own Domain

Examples:

KingdomsOfAether.com

PlayKingdomsOfAether.com

Creator purchases domain from registrar.

Creator connects domain to GFS.

GFS manages:

- SSL
- Routing
- Analytics
- Ecosystem integration

Potential pricing:

\$1-\$2/month per connected domain

Managed Domain (Future)

Potential future service.

Creator purchases through GFS.

Includes:

- Registration
- SSL
- DNS setup
- Routing

Example:

\$29 setup

Includes first year

Then:

\$24/year renewal

Not recommended for V1 due to registrar complexity.

Game Identity Pack

Rather than selling:

Custom Domain

Sell:

Game Identity Pack

Includes:

- Domain Mapping
- SSL
- Marketing Landing Page
- QR Code Generation
- Analytics
- Ecosystem Integration

Higher perceived value than domain mapping alone.

Canonical Page Rule

Regardless of custom domains:

KingdomsOfAether.com

Must always have a corresponding GFS page:

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether

This page remains permanently available.

Purpose:

- Discovery
 - SEO
 - Analytics
 - Cross-promotion
 - Platform growth
-

Wildcard Subdomain Strategy

Long-term enhancement.

Example:

kingdoms-of-aether.gamefoundrystudio.com

Additional ecosystem pages:

wiki.kingdoms-of-aether.gamefoundrystudio.com

news.kingdoms-of-aether.gamefoundrystudio.com

community.kingdoms-of-aether.gamefoundrystudio.com

Benefits:

- No creator DNS setup
- No creator SSL setup
- Premium feel
- Full GFS control
- Easier than supporting arbitrary custom domains

Requirements:

- Wildcard DNS
- Wildcard SSL
- Subdomain routing

Effort Estimates

Path URLs

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether

Effort: 1x

Wildcard Subdomains

kingdoms-of-aether.gamefoundrystudio.com

Effort: 2x

Custom Domains

kingdomsofaether.com

Effort: 4x

Custom Domains + Creator Subdomains

wiki.kingdomsofaether.com

community.kingdomsofaether.com

Effort: 8x

Important Observation

Players care far more about:

- Rewards
- Content
- Events
- Challenges

Than URL structure.

Most players will happily visit:

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether/challenges/dragon-of-the-day

if they receive:

100 Gems

Therefore:

Build ecosystem features first.

Build URL sophistication later.

Recommended Rollout Plan

V1 - Path URLs

Primary format:

gamefoundrystudio.com/kingdoms-of-aether

Simple.

Fast.

Lowest effort.

Highest value.

V2 - Wildcard Subdomains

Examples:

kingdoms-of-aether.gamefoundrystudio.com

wiki.kingdoms-of-aether.gamefoundrystudio.com

news.kingdoms-of-aether.gamefoundrystudio.com

Premium feel.

Still fully controlled by GFS.

V3 - Bring Your Own Domain

Examples:

kingdomsofaether.com

playkingdomsofaether.com

Creator purchases domain elsewhere.

GFS hosts and manages routing.

V4 - Creator Domain Subdomains

Examples:

wiki.kingdomsofaether.com

community.kingdomsofaether.com

news.kingdomsofaether.com

Highest effort.

Lowest initial priority.

DNS Architecture

Never point creators directly at an IP address.

Always point creators at a hostname controlled by GFS.

Example:

www.kingdomsofaether.com

CNAME domains.gamefoundrystudio.com

Flow:

Creator Domain

↓

CNAME

↓

domains.gamefoundrystudio.com

↓

Cloudflare

↓

Game Foundry Studio

Benefits:

- Infrastructure changes are invisible to creators
- No DNS updates required when hosting changes
- Cloudflare remains in front of all traffic
- Simplifies scaling and migration

This should be considered the preferred architecture for all future custom-domain support.

Long-Term Strategic Goal

The strategic asset is not the engine.

The strategic asset is:

Thousands of game ecosystems living under one roof.

Future players should say:

"I found this game on Game Foundry Studio."

not:

"I found this random website somewhere."

That network effect is what transforms GFS from a game creation tool into a game platform.

This is one of the strongest platform-level ideas we've discussed because it directly ties together **Game Journey** → **Community** → **Discovery** → **Marketplace** → **Retention** → **Monetization** into a single ecosystem instead of treating them as separate features.